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# Daily Current Affairs · 4 November 2026

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DAILY UPDATE · 04 NOVEMBER 2026

# 4 November 2026 — Daily Current Affairs

Selected government announcements for revision. Figures and programme periods are reproduced as stated in the source summary.

Energy & Economy

## ₹14,500 crore VGF scheme for grid-scale energy storage

The Union Cabinet approved a Viability Gap Funding (VGF) scheme with an outlay of **₹14,500 crore** to support the development of 92 GWh of grid-scale energy storage systems. Large-scale storage can help integrate renewable energy and improve electricity grid management. VGF is financial support intended to make socially or economically useful but financially challenging projects viable.

**Exam relevance:** Energy storage, solar and wind integration, grid stability and public financial support.

Official source: PIB — Cabinet releases, 4 Nov 2026.

Governance & Statistics

## VISTAR scheme approved for 2026–27 to 2030–31

VISTAR stands for **Viksit Bharat Initiative for Statistical Transformation, Analytics & Research**. It was approved as a Central Sector Scheme for 2026–27 to 2030–31. Its focus is strengthening government statistics, analytics and research systems.

**Exam relevance:** Quality and timeliness of official statistics, evidence-based policymaking and institutional statistical capacity.

Official source: PIB — Cabinet releases.

Transport · Railways

## Indian Railways records 145.07 million tonnes of freight in October 2026

According to a Ministry of Railways PIB release, Indian Railways recorded **145.07 million tonnes** of freight loading in October 2026. Freight data are useful indicators of transport, industrial activity and logistics performance.

**Exam relevance:** Distinguish freight loading from passenger transport and remember the reporting period and unit.

Official source: PIB — Railway releases, October 2026.

Science & Technology · Artificial Intelligence

## Indigenous foundation models under the IndiaAI Mission

PIB reported the release of EKA-1 and the Dhīr 2B and Dhīr 5B models under the IndiaAI Mission. A foundation model is a large-scale AI model trained on broad datasets and designed to serve as a base for multiple applications.

**Exam relevance:** Artificial intelligence, domestic technology capacity, language and data resources, and responsible AI.

Official source: PIB — IndiaAI Mission release listing.

**Daily revision method:** Select 5–10 important items each day. Record the date, institution, location, key figure, background and examination relevance.

**Daily Practice Questions — 4 November 2026**

1. What is the outlay of the grid-scale energy storage VGF scheme? **₹14,500 crore.**
2. What does VISTAR stand for? **Viksit Bharat Initiative for Statistical Transformation, Analytics & Research.**
3. How much freight did Indian Railways load in October 2026, according to the source? **145.07 million tonnes.**
4. Which mission was associated with the release of EKA-1 and Dhīr 2B and Dhīr 5B? **IndiaAI Mission.**